FT FollowThrough

The Lawn Care Playbook

What to say from the first call to the five-star review. Copy the lines, put them in your own words, and keep this on your phone.

1. The first call or message

Sound calm, understand the job, and book a next step. Ask:

- What bothers you most: weeds, bare spots, brown patches or thin grass?
- What's the address? I'll measure the lawn on the map before I quote.
- Do you have kids or pets who use the lawn?
- Is anyone treating it now, or did you put anything down this year?

> "Thanks for calling [Business], this is [Name]. Tell me what's going on with the lawn and I'll see how we can help."

> "I'll measure your lawn on the map and send a price today. Can I stop by to look at the grass Tuesday or Wednesday afternoon? You don't need to be home."

2. Presenting the quote

- Price per round by lawn size, and list every round with its timing and products.
- Say what you do if weeds come back between rounds.
- Offer a smaller program, like four rounds instead of six, or the front yard only.
- Explain how payment works: per round or spread monthly, and cancel before any round.

> "Here's your lawn's size, the rounds I'd do and what each one does, and the price per round. The next round goes down the week of [date]. What questions do you have?"

3. The 7 objections lawn care pros hear and what to say

Acknowledge it, ask a question, answer honestly, suggest a next step.

1. "The big lawn company is cheaper."
"That's worth checking. How many rounds does their price include, and do they come back free if weeds return? Many low prices cover the first round only. I'll send my program with every round and product listed so you can compare."

2. "I want to look at a few options."
"Makes sense. What bothers you most about the lawn right now? Ask each company about the number of rounds, what's in each one and the service guarantee. I'll check in Thursday, before the next round goes down."

3. "Can you do it cheaper?"
"Let's see. Would a smaller program fit? We could do four rounds instead of six, or treat only the front yard. I won't cut the product rate, because that's what makes it work."

4. "I'll just put down weed and feed myself."
"A lot of people try it. Do you know what kind of grass you have? Timing and the right product make the difference, and the wrong one can burn a lawn. I can do the treatments while you keep mowing, or the other way around."

5. “Let’s start next month.”
“We can. Have you seen crabgrass or dandelions coming up? Pre-emergent only works before weeds sprout, and once that window closes, you’re fighting weeds all summer. I can do this round now, and you can pause the rest if you change your mind.”

6. “Is it safe for my kids and pets?”
“Good question, I’d ask too. How much time do they spend on the lawn? I follow the label for every product, put out flags after each treatment and tell you when the lawn is dry and safe to use. I’ll send you the product labels before the first round.”

7. “Why do I have to sign up for the whole year?”
“Fair question. Have you been stuck in a contract you didn’t want? The program works because each round builds on the last, but you can cancel before any round. You can pay per round or spread it monthly, and if you cancel, you only pay for the rounds you got.”

4. Follow up: day 2, day 5, day 12

Most quotes go quiet, not “no”. Keep each message short and useful.

> **Day 2:** “Hi [Name], it’s [Your name] from [Business]. Did the lawn program come through okay? Happy to answer any questions.”

> **Day 5:** “Hi [Name], the next round goes down on your street the week of [date]. Want me to include your lawn?”

> **Day 12:** “Hi [Name], I’ll close out your quote on Friday. If the weeds show up later, reply and I’ll fit you into the next round.”

People buy lawn programs in early spring, when weeds show up. Follow up fast then, and send quotes the same day.

5. Ask for the review and the referral

Ask once the lawn has visibly improved, usually after the second or third round, and text a direct link to your Google review page.

> “Hi [Name], your lawn’s looking great. If you’re happy with it, would you leave a quick Google review? I’ll text you the link. And if a neighbor asks who does your lawn, I’d be glad to help.”

A green lawn sells itself to the neighbors. With the owner’s okay, leave a small sign after each treatment, and quote the houses on either side.

Three rules that keep you out of trouble

- Get your state’s applicator license before you spray or spread anything, and follow label rates, notice rules and fertilizer bans.
- Buy insurance that covers chemical application. General policies often exclude it.
- Put the program in writing, with every round, product and what you do if weeds come back.

General education, not legal, tax or insurance advice. Rules and prices vary by state, so check yours.
The full start-up guide for lawn care pros: followthroughguides.com/lawn-care · Questions: info@followthroughguides.com